

Teresa Pelinski

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RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Research Fellow

Nov. 2025–present

Creative Computing Institute, University of the Arts London

At the *Music & Artificial Intelligence: Building Critical Interdisciplinary Studies* (MusAI, 2021–2026) ERC-funded Research Programme, led by Prof Georgina Born. I'm working on the *Prototyping Radically Interdisciplinary Music AI Pedagogies* project, led by Prof Rebecca Fiebrink.

PhD Student/Researcher in AI & Music

Sept. 2021– Sept. 2026

Centre for Digital Music, Queen Mary University of London (QMUL)

Augmented Instruments Lab, QMUL (2021–2023), Imperial College London (2023–present)

Thesis title: 'Travelling the borderlands of musical instrument design: Creative-technical practice and its research narratives' [Submitted 06/07/2026; viva examination on 16/09/2026]. Supervised by Prof Andrew McPherson (Imperial College London) and Prof Rebecca Fiebrink (University of the Arts London). Other affiliations: Visiting researcher at Imperial College London (2023–2026), University of the Arts London (2023–2025) and Berlin University of the Arts (July 2024). Enrichment Scheme Award placement at the Alan Turing Institute (Oct. 2023–June 2024).

Associate Lecturer (lecturing + assessing)

Oct. 2022–Jan. 2026

Teaching courses at the MSc Applied ML for Creatives (*Creative Computing Institute, University of the Arts London*): Multimedia Coding, STEM for Creatives, Artificial Intelligence for Media, Natural Language Processing for the Creative Industries.

Teaching Assistant (tutoring + assessing)

Nov. 2024–Dec. 2024

Gizmo: Physical Computing [MEng], *Dyson School of Design Engineering, Imperial College London*

Teaching Associate (assessing)

June 2022–July 2022

Interactive Media Design and Production [BSc(Eng)], *Queen Mary University of London*

Demonstrator (tutoring + assessing)

Jan. 2022–May 2022

Interaction Design [BSc(Eng)], *Queen Mary University of London*

Software Development Internship

Apr. 2023–Sept. 2023

Bela, London

Developing *pybela*, a Python library for interfacing with the Bela embedded platform in the context of real-time musical interaction.

EDUCATION

PhD in AI & Music

Sept. 2021– Sept. 2026

Centre for Digital Music, Queen Mary University of London (QMUL)

Augmented Instruments Lab, QMUL (2021–2023), Imperial College London (2023–2026)

Fully funded doctoral scholarship (tuition, stipend, travel & research budget) awarded by the *Centre for Doctoral Training in Artificial Intelligence and Music*, supported by *UKRI* and *Bela*. Programme requirements included taking 6 graduate courses for credit, including Deep Learning for Audio and Music and Practice Research in Music Performance (the latter taken at Goldsmiths, University of London)

MSc Sound and Music Computing

Sept. 2020–Aug. 2021

Music Technology Group, Universitat Pompeu Fabra; Barcelona, Spain

60 ECTS. Average grade: 97%. Master thesis ('Completing audio drum loops with Transformer neural networks'; grade: 100%), supervised by Prof Sergi Jordà and Dr Behzad Haki at the Music and Multimodal Interaction Lab. My Computational Creativity coursework was extended into a residency at *Phonos Foundation* (2021, see more details below). Delivered the *graduation lecture* to the July 2025 Engineering cohorts (inc. Sound and Music Computing).

BSc Physics (+ year abroad on Acoustics)

Sept. 2016–June 2020

Facultad de Ciencias, Universidad Autónoma de Madrid, Spain

Institute for Hearing Technology and Acoustics, RWTH Aachen University, Germany

4 years (240 ECTS). Comb. theoretical + experimental physics, focus on theoretical physics + acoustics. Average grade: 78%. Erasmus scholarship (Oct. 2018–Sept. 2019) at the Institute for Hearing Technology and Acoustics at RWTH Aachen University (Germany), where I wrote my bachelor thesis ('Simplified binaural receivers for low frequency range acoustical simulations'; grade: 95%), supervised by MSc Philipp Schäfer and examined by Prof Michael Vorländer.

Ironhack Madrid, Spain

Oct. 2019–Apr. 2020

Full-stack web development coding bootcamp.

JOURNAL PAPERS

Pelinski, T., Green, O., Fiebrink, R., Born, G., (n.d.). Critical computing education requires more than ethics—it requires radical interdisciplinarity [Accepted, forthcoming]. *Communications of the ACM*

Pelinski, T., Melbye, A. P., McPherson, A., (2026). When AI doesn't sound like AI: Negotiating aesthetic expectations in technology-mediated musical practice. *Organised Sound*. Special issue on Embedding Algorithms in Music and Sound Art [FirstView], 1–11. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S1355771826101228>

Pelinski, T., McPherson, A., Fiebrink, R., (2024). Ways of knowing, ways of writing: Technical practice research in new musical instrument design. *Journal of New Music Research*, 53(1–2). Special Issue on Technoscientific Practices of Music: Critical Implications of New Technologies, 79–92. <https://doi.org/10.1080/09298215.2024.2442348>

CONFERENCE PAPERS

Shier, J., **Pelinski, T.**, Saitis, C., Robertson, A., McPherson, A., (2026). Rescuing performance from the demo: Co-designing drum gesture mappings with a percussionist [Accepted, forthcoming]. *Proceedings of the Conference on AI Music Creativity (AIMC 2026)*. Berlin, Germany.

Pelinski, T., Moro, G., McPherson, A., (2025). Pybela: A python library to interface scientific and physical computing. *Proceedings of the International Conference on New Interfaces for Musical Expression (NIME 2025)*, 63–72. Canberra, Australia. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.15698790>

Pelinski, T., Díaz, R., Benito Temprano, A. L., McPherson, A., (2023). Pipeline for recording datasets and running neural networks on the Bela embedded hardware platform. *Proceedings of the International Conference on New Interfaces for Musical Expression (NIME 2023)*, 160–166. Mexico City, Mexico. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.11189141>

Haki, B., **Pelinski, T.**, Nieto Giménez, M., Jordà, S., (2023). Completing audio drum loops with symbolic drum suggestions. *Proceedings of the International Conference on New Interfaces for Musical Expression (NIME 2023)*. Mexico City, Mexico. <https://doi.org/10.21428/92fbeb44.fe9a0d82>

Haki, B., Nieto, M., **Pelinski, T.**, Jordà, S., (2022). Real-time drum accompaniment using Transformer architecture. *Proceedings of the 3rd Conference on AI Music Creativity (AIMC 2022)*. Online, Anywhere. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.7088343>

Pelinski, T., (2022). Sensor mesh as performance interface [Doctoral Consortium]. *International Conference on New Interfaces for Musical Expression (NIME 2022)*. Auckland, New Zealand. <https://doi.org/10.21428/92fbeb44.ce842111>

Pelinski, T., Haki, B., Jordà, S., (2021). Completing audio drum loops with Transformer neural networks [Workshop Paper]. *Digital Musical Research Network One-Day Workshop (DMRN+16)*. Queen Mary University of London, UK. <https://qmro.qmul.ac.uk/xmlui/handle/123456789/76887>

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS WITHOUT ASSOCIATED PUBLICATION

Pelinski, T., (2026). Cyberpunk inversions and chatbot escapes [Abstract accepted, forthcoming]. *Annual Meeting of the Society for Social Studies of Science (4S 2026)*. Toronto, Canada.

Pelinski, T., Green, O., Born, G., Fiebrink, R., (2026). Prototyping radically interdisciplinary music AI pedagogies [Abstract accepted, forthcoming]. *Futures and Critical AI Literacies: Resisting inevitability narratives through creative methods and critical pedagogy panel at the European Association for the Study of Science and Technology (EASST 2026)*. Kraków, Poland.

Pelinski, T., Born, G., (2026). Beyond ethics, for a critical interdisciplinary music AI pedagogy [Conference presentation]. *AI Music Studies Conference (AIMS 2026)*. Nottingham, UK. <https://www.aims2026.com/programme>

McPherson, A., **Pelinski, T.**, (2026). Of ghosts and slop: Is there 'an' AI music aesthetic? [Conference Presentation]. *AI Music Studies Conference (AIMS 2026)*. University of Nottingham, UK. <https://www.aims2026.com/programme>

Pelinski, T., (2024). The dialectics of resistance and accommodation in debugging [Conference Presentation]. *Code as Conversation: Transmedia Dialogues Around Critical Code Studies*. University of Cambridge, Cambridge, UK.

Pelinski, T., Caspe, F., McPherson, A., Sandler, M., (2023). Computing ecosystems: Neural networks and embedded hardware platforms [Workshop Paper]. *Beyond Prototyping Boards: Future Paradigms for Electronics Toolkits Workshop at the 2023 Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI'23)*. Hamburg, Germany. <https://qmro.qmul.ac.uk/xmlui/handle/123456789/88694>

Pelinski, T., (2022). Anomaly detection as means of sensing subtlety and nuance in musical gesture [Workshop presentation]. *Embedded Perspectives on Musical AI Workshop*. Oslo, Norway. <https://www.uio.no/ritmo/english/news-and-events/events/workshops/2022/embodied-ai/p/teresa-pelinski.html>

Pelinski, T., (2022). Some considerations on the design of digital musical instruments [Invited talk]. *Jornada de Organología (Organology Meeting at Universidad Complutense de Madrid)*. Madrid, Spain.

DEGREE THESES

Pelinski, T., (2026). *Travelling the borderlands of musical instrument design: Creative-technical practice and its research narratives* [Doctoral dissertation, Queen Mary University of London] [Submitted 06/07/2026; Defence date TBC]. London, UK.

Pelinski, T., (2021). *Completing audio drum loops with transformer neural networks* [Master's thesis, Universitat Pompeu Fabra]. Barcelona, Spain. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.5554854>

Pelinski, T., (2019). *Simplified binaural receivers for low frequency range acoustical simulations* [Bachelor's thesis]. Institute for Hearing Technology and Acoustics, RWTH Aachen University. Aachen, Germany. https://www.akustik.rwth-aachen.de/cms/institut-fuer-hoertechnik-und-akustik/studium/abschlussarbeiten/abschlussarbeiten/~gkoo/details/?file=abschl_1583&lidx=1

ORGANISED CONFERENCE WORKSHOPS

Martin, C. P., **Pelinski, T.**, (2024). Building NIMEs with embedded AI [Workshop]. *International Conference on New Interfaces for Musical Expression (NIME 2024)*. Utrecht, Netherlands. <https://smcclab.github.io/nime-embedded-ai/>

Jourdan, T., **Pelinski, T.**, Scurto, H., Höök, K., (2024). First-person and second-person perspectives for ML in NIME [Workshop]. *International Conference on New Interfaces for Musical Expression (NIME 2024)*. Utrecht, Netherlands. <https://pelinski.github.io/first-and-second-person-perspectives-ml-nime/>

Armitage, J., Shepardson, V., Privato, N., **Pelinski, T.**, Benito Temprano, A. L., Wolstanholme, L., Martelloni, A., Caspe, F. S., Reed, C. N., Skach, S., Diaz, R., O'Brien, S. P., Shier, J., (2023). Agential instruments design workshop [Workshop]. *The International Conference on AI and Musical Creativity (AIMC 2023)*. The University of Sussex, Falmer, UK. <https://qmro.qmul.ac.uk/xmlui/handle/123456789/91547>

Pelinski, T., Shepardson, V., Symons, S., Caspe, F. S., Benito Temprano, A. L., Armitage, J., Kiefer, C., Fiebrink, R., Magnusson, T., McPherson, A., (2022). Embedded AI for NIME: Challenges and opportunities [Workshop]. *International Conference on New Interfaces for Musical Expression (NIME 2022)*. Auckland, New Zealand. <https://doi.org/10.21428/92fbeb44.76beab02>

AWARDS

3 grants to present at the Annual Meeting of the Society for Social Studies of Science (4S, October 2026): (1) Queen Mary University of London [Postgraduate Research Fund](#) (£1500), (2) [Professional Development Grant](#) from the Society of Spanish Researchers in the United Kingdom (£600) and (3) [4S conference travel grant](#), funded by the US National Science Foundation (NSF) (300 USD).

PhD Studentship (Sep. 2021–Sep. 2025)–EPSRC [UKRI Centre for Doctoral Training in Artificial Intelligence and Music](#) (EP/S022694/1) at Queen Mary University of London. Industrial sponsor: Bela (Augmented Instruments Ltd). Covers tuition, living expenses, travel and research budget.

[Turing Enrichment Scheme Award](#) (Oct. 2023–June 2024) placement at [The Alan Turing Institute](#), the UK's national institute for data science and artificial intelligence. Monthly stipend and research grant (£1000).

Erasmus+ grant (Sep. 2018–Sep. 2019) monthly stipend for an undergraduate exchange at RTWH Aachen University.

German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD) stipend for a C1 German course and accommodation at Ludwig Maximilian University of Munich (Aug. 2018; Hochschulsommerkurse in Deutschland für ausländische Studierende und Graduierte, 57387787).

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Workshop Chair at the International Conference on New Interfaces for Musical Expression ([NIME 2026](#)); Concert Chair at the 11th International Workshop on Haptic & Audio Interaction Design ([HAID 2022](#)).

Conference reviewer for the ACM Tangible, Embedded and Embodied Interaction Conference ([TEI 2026](#), Pictorials track), Computer Music Multidisciplinary Research Conference ([CMMR 2025](#), Music performance track), ACM Creativity & Cognition Conference. ([C&C 2025](#), Arts Track), International Conference on New Interfaces for Musical Expression ([NIME 2025](#): Paper track, workshops track, [NIME 2024](#): Paper track).

Journal reviewer for the [Journal of New Music Research](#) (2026), [IEEE Transactions on Human-Machine Systems Journal](#) (2024).

Session chair at the International Conference on New Interfaces for Musical Expression (NIME) in [NIME 2024](#), [2025](#), and [2026](#).

Member of the Scientific Committee (2024–2026) [UPF-BMAT Chair on Artificial Intelligence and Music](#).

SELECTED ARTISTIC RESIDENCIES, RELEASES AND PERFORMANCES

Sonar+D AI Performance Playground (Barcelona, June 2025). Selected to take part in the the [AI & Music Hacklab supported by S+T+ARTS, part of the music festival Sonar+D 2025](#). Performance at the Agora Stage (14/06/2025).

[Performance](#) with Adam Pultz Melbye and our *Surfing Hyperparameters* system (see Pelinski, Melbye and McPherson, [2026](#)) at the Embedded Algorithms Workshop held at the Berlin Open Lab, University

of the Arts, Berlin (26/07/2024).

Goldsmiths No Input Ensemble (London, May–June 2024). I was part of the Goldsmiths EMS No Input Ensemble. We released an [EP with NX Records \(2024\)](#). During the Spring 2023 semester I was also part of the Goldsmiths Laptop Ensemble.

Residency at Noods Radio (Bristol, Aug-Dec 2023). Presented and produced [Officium](#), an hour-long monthly radio show on sacred choral music.

Residency at Phonos Foundation (Barcelona, Oct-Jan 2021/22) developing “no shell, just a voice”, a [sound piece and web zine](#) on the body in artificially-generated voices. It was released in [La Membrana record label \(2022\)](#) and shown at the 7th Music and New Technologies International Festival “Visiones Sonoras” in Michoacán, Mexico, in 2021.

LANGUAGES

Full proficiency in English (C1 CAE, 2014), Spanish and Catalan (native). Very advanced level of German (Goethe-Zertifikat C1, 2020). Medium-basic level of French, currently working on becoming fluent and acquiring full professional proficiency.